Brad Geesaman

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Summary

Throughout my career, I have partnered with security and engineering teams to find what matters most in their environments and turn it into practical change. Most recently, as a Forward Deployed Engineer at Ghost Security, I built AI agents that do real security work for enterprise teams, with a focus on trust, transparency, safety, and leveling up my clients. Before that, I advised organizations on securing AWS, Google Cloud, and Kubernetes as a cloud security consultancy co-founder and a Google Cloud PSO consultant. My background also includes vuln research, pen-testing, security operations, and CTF/cyber range development.

Experience

Principal Security Engineer / Forward Deployed Engineer, Ghost Security 2022-2026

- Worked directly with enterprise security teams to understand their workflows and priorities, then designed and built production AI agents, and the platforms they run on, delivering AI-native application security scanning across more than 15,000 enterprise repositories.
- Translated customer and community feedback into product and sales priorities so that features landed and delivered value.
- Built the core foundation of Ghost's cloud and application security repository scanning platform on GCP using serverless technologies (Cloud Run/Jobs, Cloud Tasks, GCS, Firestore, Container Analysis, and more).
- Represented Ghost in the AppSec and developer community with vulnerability research, talks, workshops, blogs, videos, and releases of open-source application security `SKILL` repos.
- Led R&D of agentic-AI application security platform capabilities, including ReaperBot, an agentic framework for autonomous web app recon and fuzz testing via Reaper.
- Responsible for all SRE, Code Security, and platform security posture activities in our GCP and AWS environments.

Director of Cloud Security, Aqua Security 2021-2022

- Technical lead for research and early product development of agentless cloud and container security capabilities across AWS, Azure, and Google Cloud.
- Designed and prototyped block store and disk snapshot scanning of cloud workloads and container hosts, which landed a major streaming video service as the first customer.

Co-founder, Chief Architect, Darkbit.io 2019-2021

- Advised engineering and security leaders at cloud-native organizations on the security posture of their AWS, Google Cloud, and Kubernetes environments through point-in-time assessments and continuous monitoring engagements.
- Turned assessment findings into prioritized remediation plans fit to each client's architecture and engineering capacity.
- Co-developed and open-sourced OpenCSPM, a graph-database engine for efficiently assessing the security posture of AWS, Google Cloud, and Kubernetes resources.
- Developed and tested exam challenges for the Certified Kubernetes Security Specialist (CKS) certification.

Professional Services Consultant (Contractor/TVC), Google Cloud (PSO) 2018-2020

- Engaged with multiple clients migrating to Google Cloud and Google Kubernetes Engine (GKE). Performed security configuration reviews with strategic security guidance to client management.
- Delivered multiple internal GKE/Security educational assets and training sessions used by the greater Google Cloud Partner ecosystem.
- One of the first 20 to qualify for the Google Cloud Certified Fellow Program.

Independent Security Consultant, Bradley Geesaman Consulting 2018-2020

- Delivered practical security guidance, expertise, implementation assistance, and security training to several clients deploying mission-critical workloads inside Kubernetes on bare metal, AWS, and GKE.
- Designed, developed, and automated the cluster and deployment pipelines of a multi-team AWS/Kubernetes-based platform performing security analytics at 60K logs/sec into Elasticsearch.

Senior Manager, CTF/Simulation Development, Symantec Corporation 2015-2017

- Led the CTF/simulation development team behind the Symantec Cyberwar Games and Cyberskills exercises, played by over 5,000 ethical hackers.
- Led the team that successfully hosted a one-week, 1500 person, company-wide Capture-the-Flag event inside 10 AWS regions on top of multiple, hardened Kubernetes clusters.
- Architected and built a fully automated Kubernetes cluster deployment tool on AWS to support the containerized targets on the Symantec Cyberskills platform.
- Built and managed the federated logging and performance system used to monitor cluster and container health using ELK and Prometheus/Grafana.

CTO, Blackfin Security Group - Acquired by Symantec Corporation 2014-2015

- Led the technical operations team focused on delivering cutting-edge, realistic, and immersive training solutions to improve security awareness for large organizations and "hands-on" experience to expert security personnel charged with defending their data.
- Managed the Customer Support, Operations, and Internal IT teams.
- Administered The Hacker Academy, an ethical hacking subscription learning platform on top of AWS via Infrastructure as Code and Configuration Management.

Chief Architect, MAD Security 2012-2014

- Led and managed the team that designed, built, and delivered capture-the-flag (CTF) style ethical hacking/cyber wargames challenges designed for security professionals. The challenges have been played by over 9,000 professionals world-wide in over 200 events of 20-1,000 participants, lasting 2 hours to 30 days (24/7).
- Delivered several one-day bootcamp instructional training sessions covering security penetration-testing basic concepts complete with custom CTF scenarios for hands-on skills reinforcement.

Sales Engineer, Check Point Software Technologies 2008-2012

- Responsible for technical pre-sales support for the design, migration/implementation, and operation of security gateway solutions for Federal Civilian Agencies.
- "2009 North American Security Engineer of the Year" Award for outstanding team performance and customer satisfaction.

Manager, Security Assessment Services, Securicon 2006-2008

- Managed numerous security assessments and audits from kick-off to final delivery for financial, power/energy, and gas pipeline companies. Led small teams in electronic and physical penetration testing, vulnerability assessments, and solutions review.
- Formalized and streamlined the client engagement assessment data collection process to reduce final deliverable draft and completion time by up to 50%.

Earlier Roles 2002-2006

- Security Engineer to Principal Security Engineer, Symantec Managed Security Services (2003-2006): Tier 3 SOC engineering support for Fortune 100/500 customers, and built a fault and performance monitoring system that cut 5% of daily engineering workload.
- Systems Engineer, PEC Solutions (2002-2003): secure transmission of electronic fingerprints and photos for Federal hiring at remote sites.

Speaking

Ghost Security Agent Skills - Scan-Code	Ghost Security 2026
From Toil to Intelligence: The Future of AppSec with AI Agents	Boring AppSec Podcast 2025
AI in AppSec: The Paradigm Shift	Scale to Zero Podcast 2025
Malicious Compliance: Reflections on Trusting Container Scanners	KubeCon EU 2023
Exploiting a Slightly Peculiar Volume Configuration with SIG-Honk	KubeCon NA 2021
Kubernetes Exposed! Seven of Nine Hidden Secrets That Will Give You Pause	KubeCon NA 2021
Keynote Panel: Hacking and Hardening in the Cloud Native Garden	KubeCon NA 2020
Kubernetes Attacks: What Your Cluster Is Trying To Tell You	CSA Boston Oct 2020
Advanced Persistence Threats: The Future of Kubernetes Attacks	RSA 2020/KubeCon EU 2020
Attacking and Defending Kubernetes Clusters: A Guided Tour	KubeCon NA 2019
Detecting Malicious Cloud Account Behavior	BlackHat USA 2018

Hacking and Hardening Kubernetes Clusters By Example — KubeCon NA 2017

Vuln Research

CVE-2026-53950 High-Severity XSS in Ghost CMS ActivityPub Client, found using Ghost Security AI Skills — 2026

CVE-2020-15157 "ContainerDrip" Write-up (advisory) and Google 2020 VRP Prize Winner — 2020

Falco Default Rule Bypass

Container Registry Search Order/Registry Name Squatting

CVE-2019-11253 Kubernetes DoS Writeup — 2019

kube-env-stealer - Automated GKE kubelet impersonation and cluster secret stealer via kube-env

subpath-exploit - CVE-2017-1002101 write-up with sample exploit/escape — 2018

Open Source

ghostsecurity/skills - AppSec skills for AI coding agents — 2026

ghostsecurity/reaper - Live validation proxy for testing web app vulnerabilities — 2022

OpenCSPM - Graph-based cloud security posture management engine for AWS, Google Cloud, and Kubernetes — 2020

darkbitio/gcp-iam-role-permissions - Continuously updated export of all GCP IAM roles and their permissions

Certifications

Google Cloud Certified Fellow: Hybrid Multicloud (program retired) — 2020-2024

Certified Kubernetes Security Specialist Exam Developer — 2020

Google Cloud Certified Professional Cloud Architect — 2019-2021

Certified Information System Security Professional (CISSP), ISC2 — 2007-2016

RedHat Enterprise Linux Certified Engineer (RHCE), RHEL 3.0 — 2004-2006

Education

BBA, Computer Information Systems, James Madison University, VA, USA. — 1998-2002

Interests

Hockey, Formula 1™, Cloud/Kubernetes Vulnerability Hunting, running local LLMs, Mexican food, and collecting e-books